

How a top 1% business plans the next 90 days

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Jul 27, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pBm0WFt0SU8> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Tim Luong films his company's 3-day executive leadership offsite in LA, showing how a ~10M/year business uses EOS principles, an outside facilitator, and 90-day "rocks" to reflect on Q2, solve cross-department problems, and lock in Q3 priorities.

Contents

- 🏠 Setting the Scene: The Quarterly Offsite
- 📝 Pre-Work: The Brain-Vomit Google Doc
- 🎯 The Core Philosophy: Fewer Goals, Higher Leverage
- 🔍 Day 1 & 2: Reflecting, IDS, and Solving Problems
- 👤 Finding the Right Sales Leader
- 🤝 Day 3: The Outside Facilitator (EOS Implementer)
- 🏗️ EOS Framework: Vision, Traction, Healthy
- 🪨 Locking In Quarterly Rocks
- ✅ Post-Offsite Wrap-Up

Setting the Scene: The Quarterly Offsite 0:02

- Tim rents a house in LA for the entire executive team for 3 days
 - Usually held in Miami; this quarter it's in LA
 - Described as **14-hour days** for all 3 days
- Executive team present:
 - Grant — operations
 - Blue — marketing
 - Jimmy — sales (brand new hire, first time meeting in person)
- The purpose of meeting in person vs. remotely:
 - Move significantly faster on decisions
 - Enables tough, direct conversations that are harder remotely
 - Builds team community and dynamic
- Format overview:
 - Day 1: Review Q2 — what went well, what didn't

- Day 2: Deep IDS (Identify, Discuss, Solve) sessions across departments
- Day 3: Outside facilitator joins to align, finalize, and lock in Q3 plan
- Who this applies to:
 - Sub \$1–2M/year businesses: *don't need this yet* — focus on leads, closing, and fulfillment
 - **10–12 person teams**: start incorporating pieces of this
 - **30–35 person teams**: this becomes essential to stay organized
 - Smaller businesses can still extract the core principles and apply them solo or with a small leadership group

Pre-Work: The Brain-Vomit Google Doc 1:41

- Before the offsite, Tim prepares a **6-page prep document**
 - Method: stream-of-consciousness "brain vomit" into a Google Doc
- Document is broken out by every department:
 - Marketing
 - Sales
 - Customer Success
 - Products
 - Tech, Ops & Data
 - Finance
 - ~10 different items listed under **each** department to solve
- Document also includes:
 - Q3 projections — specific revenue/cash targets on a monthly basis
 - The *how* behind hitting those numbers, not just a vanity revenue goal
 - Company rocks (top priorities for the whole company next 90 days)
 - Department rocks (3–6 highest-leverage items per department)
- Goal of the pre-work: walk into the offsite with a clear problem list so in-person time is spent solving, not identifying

The Core Philosophy: Fewer Goals, Higher Leverage 2:35

- **The single most important piece of advice Tim gives:** have fewer goals
 - Maximum of **3 rocks** per person/department per quarter
 - 3 rocks = significantly higher success rate of actually moving the needle
 - 4, 5, or 6 goals = spread too thin, nothing gets done
- Rocks are the *highest-leverage* things — the items that move the needle the most
- How to identify what the highest-leverage things actually are:
 - Step 1: Spend significant time reflecting on last quarter

- Step 2: Review what goals were set — which were hit, which weren't
- Step 3: Ask whether those were even the *right* goals in the first place
- Step 4: Identify all the lingering unsolved problems from the previous quarter (these become your IDS list)
- Step 5: Solve those problems department by department
- Step 6: After all that reflection and problem-solving, the right 90-day priorities become obvious
- Common mistake Tim warns against:
 - Most people jump straight to goal-setting without enough reflection or problem-solving first
 - Result: rowing in the wrong direction, misaligned team effort
- The CEO/founder's job is alignment:
 - "Your job as the CEO and founder is to get people aligned on the vision."
 - Vague goals = team members each interpret the goal differently and execute in different directions
 - Clear rocks = A-players can run without micromanagement

Day 1 & 2: Reflecting, IDS, and Solving Problems 4:53

- Day 1 is primarily Q2 review and getting everyone situated
- Day 2 is ~10 hours of nonstop IDS (Identify, Discuss, Solve) sessions
 - Tim notes: "My brain is cooked" by 5 p.m.
 - Some individual problems took **~45 minutes** to solve
 - Problems Tim didn't even want to bring up — but the in-person format forces resolution
- Key insight on why 3 days of planning is worth it: > "These 3 days would dictate the 90 days... your 3 days is the 80/20."
 - Spending 90 days rowing in the wrong direction is far more costly than 3 days of deep planning
 - Some call it "overkill" — Tim argues it's the highest-leverage use of time
- By end of Day 2, the team has solved major cross-department problems and is nearly ready for facilitator session

Finding the Right Sales Leader 6:15

- Jimmy is the new sales leader — only a few weeks into the role, first time meeting Tim in person
- Context on how hard this hire was:
 - Tim went through **4 wrong sales leaders** over the past year before finding Jimmy
 - Described the process as "an absolute nightmare" and "a lot of pain"
- What makes a great executive hire difficult:
 - Must have the skills to take the company to the next level
 - Must be a strong culture fit
 - Must mesh with the existing team

- Must genuinely care about the business — not just the paycheck
- Broader point on competition at scale:
 - Being a **\$10M/year business** = top **0.4% of all businesses**
 - To scale to **\$30M or \$50M/year**, you're competing against even more elite operators
 - The only way to get there is to continuously elevate the talent level on the team

Day 3: The Outside Facilitator (EOS Implementer) 9:28

- Gerardo joins on Day 3 as an outside facilitator
 - His title: **EOS Implementer**
 - Gerardo's three roles with the team:
 - **Facilitator** — asks the right questions; the team already has the answers
 - **Coach** — observes from the outside, spots what's working/not working that the team can't see from inside
 - **Teacher** — trains the team on the EOS framework pillars
- Why an outside facilitator matters:
 - Internal teams have **blind spots** — they're too close to the day-to-day
 - Internal teams share the same narrative daily, so false assumptions can calcify into "truth"
 - An outsider can challenge those assumptions: "Is that actually true?"
 - Gerardo is described as "smoking out" issues the team wasn't even raising themselves
- Tim's broader point on outside accountability:
 - VC-backed companies have **boards of advisors** who review numbers and call out problems every month/quarter
 - Without outside accountability, blind spots compound indefinitely
 - Getting to 8 figures without outside help is possible; *maintaining and growing* past that without it is not
 - "There's no way you get eight figures a year if you don't have structure, process, systems, team, leadership, management."

EOS Framework: Vision, Traction, Healthy 11:16

- EOS stands for Entrepreneurial Operating System
- The three pillars Gerardo describes:

Pillar	What It Means	Key Risk If Ignored
Vision	Where the business is heading; everyone rowing in the same direction	Leaders hold vision in their head but never put it on paper or share it — team drifts
Traction	Execution discipline; keeping focus; accountability to progress	Lack of discipline causes teams to lose focus and fragment

Pillar	What It Means	Key Risk If Ignored
Healthy	How the team behaves together; cohesive, conflict-capable culture	Avoiding hard conversations leads to buried issues that eventually explode

- On **Vision**:
 - The visionary (Tim) has "crazy dreams" that galvanize the team
 - But vision must be shared, written down, and have energy aligned to it — not just exist in the founder's head
- On **Traction**:
 - Brings accountability — team members call each other out
 - Ensures progress is made toward the vision, not just activity
- On **Healthy** (the most overlooked pillar):
 - Early-stage founders lack skills to manage conflict — issues get swept under the rug until they explode
 - "Healthy conflict" = passionate conversations where you attack the *issue*, never the *person*
 - After hard conversations with the company's greater good in mind, the team comes out "stronger and more bonded"
 - Most teams skip this entirely — it's what separates high-performing teams from average ones

Locking In Quarterly Rocks 15:05

- Final session of Day 3: confirming and clarifying all 90-day rocks
 - Each leader leaves knowing their personal rocks and their department's rocks
 - No micromanagement needed — A-players take the rocks and execute
- Tim's comment after rocks are locked: "It's very clear. We got our work cut out."
- The facilitator session accelerates clarity dramatically:
 - Blue (in the room, observing): "Being in the room right there — insane. The way this guy is smoking out everything."
 - "Every company needs to do something like this."
- One key identified in the session is described as potentially **doubling the business within 90 days**
- The rocks process connects directly to the earlier philosophy: 3 focused rocks per department > a long list of vague goals

Post-Offsite Wrap-Up 15:51

- Everyone is exhausted at the end of Day 3; Gerardo is energized (he feeds off people energy)
- Overall sentiment: everyone is happy, aligned, and clear on what comes next
- A few lingering items still to solve — but the major work is done
- Tim's personal decision after the offsite:

- Had originally planned to stay in New York for fun after LA
- After seeing the output of the offsite and how much Q3 requires, **booked a flight straight back to Miami** to get to work
- "I need to just go home and buckle down because we got a busy few months."
- Final takeaway framing:
 - The 3-day offsite is the 80/20 of the entire quarter
 - Clarity × aligned team × clear rocks = maximum output over the next 90 days